

GED Social Studies Practice Test 8

PART A — QUESTIONS

GED-SOC8-001

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A state constitution says that money from the state treasury may be spent only after the legislature passes an appropriation. The governor may recommend a budget, but agencies cannot spend funds unless the legislature authorizes the spending by law.

Which civic principle is most directly reflected in this source?

- A) Legislative control over public spending
- B) Judicial appointment of governors
- C) Military control of state agencies
- D) Private ownership of tax revenue

GED-SOC8-002

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A city tracks the average price of a bus pass.

Year: 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023

Average price: \$60, \$63, \$66, \$72

Which conclusion is best supported by the data?

- A) The average bus pass price increased over the period.
- B) The average bus pass price decreased every year.
- C) The average bus pass price stayed at \$60.
- D) The average bus pass price doubled by 2023.

GED-SOC8-003

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Source:

In the 1790s, political leaders disagreed over the creation of a national bank. Supporters argued that the federal government needed the bank to manage debt, collect taxes, and support commerce. Opponents argued that the Constitution did not clearly list the power to create such a bank and warned against expanding federal power too far.

Which issue was central to this debate?

- A) How broadly the Constitution's powers should be interpreted
- B) Whether the United States should return to British rule
- C) Whether the federal government should abolish all taxes
- D) How many senators each state should have

GED-SOC8-004

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A country has several climate zones. The northern area has short growing seasons and forests. The central valley has mild temperatures and supports fruit farming. The southern desert has mining towns near mineral deposits but little agriculture.

Which statement best explains the pattern described?

- A) Climate and resources influence economic activity in different regions.
- B) All regions in a country must have the same economy.
- C) Deserts always support more farming than valleys.
- D) Forest regions cannot support any economic activity.

GED-SOC8-005

Section: Social Studies

Type: multi_select

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Select TWO answers.

A state requires judges to remove themselves from cases when they have a financial interest in the outcome or a close family relationship with one of the parties.

Which TWO civic purposes are supported by this requirement?

- A) It helps protect impartial decision-making in courts.
- B) It reduces the risk that personal interests affect legal judgments.
- C) It allows judges to decide cases involving their own businesses.
- D) It gives private citizens power to rewrite court opinions.
- E) It removes the need for written laws.

GED-SOC8-006

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Paired sources:

Source A:

A state official argues that setting school curriculum is mainly a state responsibility. The official says that state education boards can respond to local needs, graduation requirements, and workforce goals.

Source B:

A federal official argues that national education funding should include certain requirements, such as reporting graduation rates and protecting students from discrimination. The official says federal money should support broad national goals.

What is the main disagreement between the two sources?

- A) Whether education policy should be shaped mainly by state authority or federal funding conditions
- B) Whether schools should stop teaching reading and math
- C) Whether courts should replace teachers in classrooms
- D) Whether students should be allowed to vote in Congress

GED-SOC8-007

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

In the 1820s and 1830s, changes in voting rules allowed many white men who did not own property to vote. Political parties organized rallies, newspapers, and campaign events to appeal to a wider electorate. However, women, most African Americans, and Native Americans were still excluded from voting in most places.

Which statement best summarizes this period?

- A) Political participation expanded for some groups while remaining limited for others.
- B) Voting rights became equal for all adults.
- C) Political parties disappeared from public life.
- D) Property ownership requirements increased everywhere.

GED-SOC8-008

Section: Social Studies

Type: dropdown

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

The power to coin money is an example of [D1], while the power to conduct elections is generally an example of [D2] subject to constitutional limits.

Dropdowns:

D1) a federal power | a county-only power | a private business power

D2) state authority | military authority | foreign authority

GED-SOC8-009

Section: Social Studies

Type: numeric_entry

Category: Economics

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A local government collected \$75 million in property taxes last year and \$81 million this year. By how many million dollars did property tax revenue increase?

Type your answer as a whole number.

GED-SOC8-010

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A region located between two larger trading areas develops busy border towns. Truck stops, warehouses, markets, and customs offices grow near crossing points. When a new border agreement reduces paperwork, trade through the region increases.

Which conclusion is best supported by this scenario?

- A) Political borders and trade rules can shape economic activity.
- B) Border regions cannot become centers of trade.
- C) Reducing paperwork always stops commerce.
- D) Warehouses develop only in coastal regions.

GED-SOC8-011

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Source:

A state law requires public colleges to give students notice of disciplinary charges and a chance to respond before suspension. The rule does not decide whether a student is responsible, but it requires a fair process before a serious penalty is imposed.

Which constitutional idea is most closely connected to this rule?

- A) Procedural due process
- B) State power to sign treaties
- C) Legislative privilege
- D) Military jurisdiction over schools

GED-SOC8-012

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A table shows cotton textile workers in one industrial city.

Year: 1830, 1850, 1870

Workers: 4,500, 14,000, 29,000

Which statement is best supported by the data?

- A) The number of textile workers increased from 1830 to 1870.
- B) The number of textile workers decreased after 1830.
- C) The number of textile workers was highest in 1830.
- D) The number of textile workers stayed exactly the same.

GED-SOC8-013

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A city charter says that the city manager is hired by the council to supervise daily operations, hire department heads, and prepare reports. The elected council sets policy and can replace the manager if performance is poor.

Which statement best describes this form of local government?

- A) Elected officials set policy while a professional administrator manages daily operations.
- B) Courts appoint all city workers and write ordinances.
- C) The city manager replaces the need for elected officials.
- D) Voters directly manage every city department.

GED-SOC8-014

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A state increases the minimum wage. Supporters argue that workers with low wages will have more income to spend. Some small business owners argue that higher labor costs may lead them to raise prices or reduce hiring.

Which conclusion is best supported by this scenario?

- A) Wage policies can have different effects on workers, consumers, and employers.
- B) Wage policies affect only government employees.
- C) Higher wages never affect business costs.
- D) Employers and workers always agree about wage laws.

GED-SOC8-015

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A state requires that criminal laws clearly define prohibited conduct. Courts may reject laws that are so vague that ordinary people cannot understand what behavior is illegal or that allow officials to enforce the law arbitrarily.

Which civic purpose is best supported by this requirement?

- A) Fair notice and protection against arbitrary enforcement
- B) Secret lawmaking by state officials
- C) Unlimited punishment without legal standards
- D) Removal of courts from legal interpretation

GED-SOC8-016

Section: Social Studies

Type: multi_select

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Select TWO answers.

During the early 1900s, some cities adopted commission or city-manager systems. Reformers argued that professional administration could reduce corruption and make services such as sanitation, water, and transportation more efficient.

Which TWO conclusions are best supported by this description?

- A) Progressive reformers tried to change local government structures.
- B) Urban services were part of reform debates.
- C) Reformers wanted to eliminate all city services.
- D) Professional administration was unrelated to city government.
- E) Reformers opposed every attempt to reduce corruption.

GED-SOC8-017

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A country reports the share of workers by economic sector.

Sector: Agriculture, Manufacturing, Services

Share of workers: 18%, 27%, 55%

Which sector employs the largest share of workers?

- A) Agriculture
- B) Manufacturing
- C) Services
- D) Agriculture and Manufacturing equally

GED-SOC8-018

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A state court rules that a city cannot charge candidates a filing fee so high that only wealthy people can run for local office, unless the city provides a reasonable alternative for candidates who cannot afford the fee.

Which conclusion is best supported by the ruling?

- A) Election rules should not unfairly limit ballot access based on wealth.
- B) Only wealthy candidates may run for public office.
- C) Cities may cancel elections when fees are unpaid.
- D) Courts cannot review election procedures.

GED-SOC8-019

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A table shows average hourly output at a workshop.

Year: 2021, 2022, 2023

Units produced per worker per hour: 12, 15, 18

Which conclusion is best supported by the data?

- A) Labor productivity increased each year.
- B) Labor productivity decreased each year.
- C) Workers produced the same number of units each year.
- D) Productivity was lowest in 2023.

GED-SOC8-020

Section: Social Studies

Type: dropdown

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

During the Red Scare after World War I, fear of [D1] contributed to raids, deportations, and restrictions on some political speech and organizing. The period shows tension between national security concerns and [D2].

Dropdowns:

D1) radical political movements | colonial taxation | westward farming

D2) civil liberties | railroad construction | protective tariffs

GED-SOC8-021

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A city council has 24 members. A proposal requires approval by three-fourths of the council.

How many council members must approve the proposal?

- A) 12
- B) 16
- C) 18
- D) 20

GED-SOC8-022

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A state law requires that a person serving on a jury be selected from a broad pool of eligible residents rather than from a list controlled by one official. The goal is to make juries more representative of the community.

Which civic principle is most directly supported by this law?

- A) Fairness in the jury system
- B) Executive power over foreign policy
- C) Legislative control of military forces
- D) State authority to coin money

GED-SOC8-023

Section: Social Studies

Type: numeric_entry

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A city has 420,000 residents. A survey estimates that 15% of residents were born in another country. How many residents were born in another country?

Type your answer as a whole number.

GED-SOC8-024

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Source:

During the 1980s, some factories closed or moved production to places with lower costs. Workers in older industrial cities faced job losses, and local governments struggled with shrinking tax bases. Some communities tried to attract service industries, technology firms, or new educational institutions.

Which broader historical change is described?

- A) Economic restructuring away from older manufacturing centers
- B) The beginning of the American Revolution
- C) The end of all urban employment
- D) The return of the United States to colonial rule

GED-SOC8-025

Section: Social Studies

Type: drag_drop

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Match each target with the correct tile.

Tiles:

- A) Appropriation
- B) Ordinance
- C) Due process
- D) Recusal

Targets:

- T1) A local law passed by a city or town government
- T2) Legal authorization for government spending
- T3) A judge stepping aside from a case because of a conflict of interest

GED-SOC8-026

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A country imports most of its coffee. A poor harvest in several coffee-growing countries reduces the amount of coffee available for export. Coffee prices rise in grocery stores.

Which economic concept best explains the price increase?

- A) A decrease in supply can lead to higher prices.
- B) A decrease in supply always lowers prices.
- C) Imported goods are not affected by harvests.
- D) Prices rise only when demand disappears.

GED-SOC8-027

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A state requires public officials to take an oath promising to support the state constitution and the U.S. Constitution before taking office.

Which civic idea is best reflected by this requirement?

- A) Public officials are bound by constitutional limits.
- B) Public officials may ignore written constitutions.
- C) Only judges must follow constitutional rules.
- D) Oaths replace elections in choosing officials.

GED-SOC8-028

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A federal court follows a previous Supreme Court ruling when deciding a similar case. The judge explains that lower courts generally must follow higher court decisions on the same constitutional issue.

Which legal principle is most directly illustrated?

- A) Precedent
- B) Initiative
- C) Remittance
- D) Gerrymandering

GED-SOC8-029

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A desert city grows because of air-conditioning, highways, and water brought from distant rivers and reservoirs. As the city expands, officials debate how to balance growth with long-term water availability.

Which statement best explains the geographic issue?

- A) Technology and infrastructure can support settlement but may increase pressure on scarce resources.
- B) Desert cities cannot grow under any conditions.
- C) Water availability has no connection to urban planning.
- D) Highways eliminate the need for natural resources.

GED-SOC8-030

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A state reports court case filings.

Case type: Civil, Criminal, Family, Traffic

Cases filed: 18,000, 12,500, 9,500, 20,000

How many total cases were filed?

- A) 50,000
- B) 55,000
- C) 60,000
- D) 65,000

GED-SOC8-031

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A state constitution allows the legislature to create special districts for services such as water, transit, or fire protection. These districts may collect fees or taxes only for the service they are legally created to provide.

Which statement best describes special districts?

- A) They are local government units created for specific public services.
- B) They are foreign governments operating inside a state.
- C) They replace all state and federal law.
- D) They exist only to conduct criminal trials.

GED-SOC8-032

Section: Social Studies

Type: multi_select

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

Select TWO answers.

A county reports the number of provisional ballots and how many were accepted after review.

Reason for provisional ballot: Address issue, Missing ID, Name not on list, Other

Ballots cast: 300, 180, 260, 60

Ballots accepted: 210, 90, 130, 30

Which TWO statements are supported by the data?

- A) Address issue had the largest number of provisional ballots cast.
- B) Missing ID had 90 ballots accepted.
- C) Other had more ballots cast than Name not on list.
- D) Name not on list had 260 ballots accepted.
- E) Address issue had fewer accepted ballots than Other.

GED-SOC8-033

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A table shows the number of farms using tractors in one state.

Year: 1920, 1930, 1940

Farms using tractors: 8,000, 31,000, 79,000

Which statement is best supported by the table?

- A) Tractor use on farms increased from 1920 to 1940.
- B) Tractor use on farms decreased after 1920.
- C) Tractor use was highest in 1920.
- D) Tractor use stayed the same during the period.

GED-SOC8-034

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A state supreme court rules that a governor cannot continue using emergency powers after the time limit set by state law unless the legislature renews the authority.

Which conclusion is best supported by the ruling?

- A) Executive power can be limited by laws enacted through the legislature.
- B) Governors may use emergency powers forever without legal limits.
- C) Legislatures have no role in defining emergency authority.
- D) Courts cannot interpret limits on executive power.

GED-SOC8-035

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A local election office conducts a recount when the margin between two candidates is less than 0.5%. The recount follows written procedures, uses bipartisan observation teams, and checks the paper record of each ballot.

Which claim is best supported by the source?

- A) Recount procedures can help verify close election results.
- B) Recounts are used to cancel elections automatically.
- C) Written procedures are unnecessary in close elections.
- D) Paper ballot records prevent election officials from reviewing results.

PART B — ANSWER KEY + EXPLANATIONS

GED-SOC8-001 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Legislative control over public spending — Explanation: The source states that public money can be spent only after legislative authorization.

GED-SOC8-002 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: The average bus pass price increased over the period. — Explanation: The price rose from \$60 in 2020 to \$72 in 2023.

GED-SOC8-003 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: How broadly the Constitution's powers should be interpreted — Explanation: The bank debate involved disagreement over implied federal powers and constitutional interpretation.

GED-SOC8-004 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Climate and resources influence economic activity in different regions. — Explanation: The source links forests, farming, mining, climate, and mineral deposits to regional economic activity.

GED-SOC8-005 — Correct: A,B — Correct Answer: It helps protect impartial decision-making in courts. | It reduces the risk that personal interests affect legal judgments. — Explanation: Recusal rules help prevent conflicts of interest from affecting court decisions.

GED-SOC8-006 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Whether education policy should be shaped mainly by state authority or federal funding conditions — Explanation: Source A emphasizes state control, while Source B emphasizes federal funding requirements.

GED-SOC8-007 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Political participation expanded for some groups while remaining limited for others. — Explanation: Voting expanded for many white men but still excluded women, most African Americans, and Native Americans.

GED-SOC8-008 — Correct: D1=a federal power; D2=state authority — Correct Answer: D1=a federal power; D2=state authority — Explanation: Coining money is a federal power, while states generally conduct elections within constitutional limits.

GED-SOC8-009 — Correct: 6 — Tolerance: exact — Correct Answer: 6 — Explanation: \$81 million minus \$75 million equals an increase of \$6 million.

GED-SOC8-010 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Political borders and trade rules can shape economic activity. — Explanation: Border towns grow because crossing points and reduced trade paperwork increase economic activity.

GED-SOC8-011 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Procedural due process — Explanation: Notice and a chance to respond are fair procedures before a serious penalty.

GED-SOC8-012 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: The number of textile workers increased from 1830 to 1870. — Explanation: Workers increased from 4,500 to 29,000.

GED-SOC8-013 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Elected officials set policy while a professional administrator manages daily operations. — Explanation: A council-manager system separates policy decisions from daily administration.

GED-SOC8-014 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Wage policies can have different effects on workers, consumers, and employers. — Explanation: The scenario describes possible benefits for workers and possible costs for employers and consumers.

GED-SOC8-015 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Fair notice and protection against arbitrary enforcement — Explanation: Clear criminal laws help people know what is prohibited and limit arbitrary enforcement.

GED-SOC8-016 — Correct: A,B — Correct Answer: Progressive reformers tried to change local government structures. | Urban services were part of reform debates. — Explanation: Commission and city-manager systems were local government reforms tied to improving urban services.

GED-SOC8-017 — Correct: C — Correct Answer: Services — Explanation: Services employ 55% of workers, the largest share.

GED-SOC8-018 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Election rules should not unfairly limit ballot access based on wealth. — Explanation: The ruling allows filing rules but requires a reasonable alternative for candidates who cannot afford high fees.

GED-SOC8-019 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Labor productivity increased each year. — Explanation: Units produced per worker per hour rose from 12 to 18.

GED-SOC8-020 — Correct: D1=radical political movements; D2=civil liberties — Correct Answer: D1=radical political movements; D2=civil liberties — Explanation: The Red Scare involved fear of radical movements and raised civil-liberties concerns.

GED-SOC8-021 — Correct: C — Correct Answer: 18 — Explanation: Three-fourths of 24 is 18.

GED-SOC8-022 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Fairness in the jury system — Explanation: A broad jury pool helps make juries more representative and fair.

GED-SOC8-023 — Correct: 63000 — Tolerance: exact — Correct Answer: 63000 — Explanation: 15% of 420,000 is 63,000.

GED-SOC8-024 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Economic restructuring away from older manufacturing centers — Explanation: The source describes factory closures, job losses, shrinking tax bases, and efforts to attract new industries.

GED-SOC8-025 — Correct: T1=B; T2=A; T3=D — Correct Answer: T1=Ordinance; T2=Appropriation; T3=Recusal — Explanation: An ordinance is a local law, an appropriation authorizes spending, and recusal means stepping aside because of a conflict.

GED-SOC8-026 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: A decrease in supply can lead to higher prices. — Explanation: A poor harvest reduces coffee supply, which can raise prices.

GED-SOC8-027 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Public officials are bound by constitutional limits. — Explanation: The oath requires officials to support written constitutional rules.

GED-SOC8-028 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Precedent — Explanation: Precedent means courts follow earlier decisions, especially decisions from higher courts on similar issues.

GED-SOC8-029 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Technology and infrastructure can support settlement but may increase pressure on scarce resources. — Explanation: Air-conditioning, highways, and imported water support desert growth but increase water-management concerns.

GED-SOC8-030 — Correct: C — Correct Answer: 60,000 — Explanation: $18,000 + 12,500 + 9,500 + 20,000 = 60,000$.

GED-SOC8-031 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: They are local government units created for specific public services. — Explanation: Special districts provide specific services such as water, transit, or fire protection.

GED-SOC8-032 — Correct: A,B — Correct Answer: Address issue had the largest number of provisional ballots cast. | Missing ID had 90 ballots accepted. — Explanation: Address issue had the highest number cast at 300, and Missing ID had 90 accepted ballots.

GED-SOC8-033 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Tractor use on farms increased from 1920 to 1940. — Explanation: Farms using tractors increased from 8,000 to 79,000.

GED-SOC8-034 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Executive power can be limited by laws enacted through the legislature. — Explanation: The ruling enforces a legal time limit on emergency powers unless the legislature renews authority.

GED-SOC8-035 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Recount procedures can help verify close election results. — Explanation: Written procedures, observers, and paper records help confirm results in a close election.